Brahms' Lullaby

Johannes Brahms, 1868

Key: **C major** Time: **3/4** Tempo: **80 bpm** First note: **E** Picked: **Up, twice a bar**

Picking to sing along to: the pattern is the accompaniment, the tune is your voice's job. Your first note is **E**: pick or hum it before you start.

The pattern

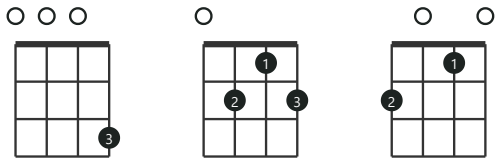
Up, twice a bar `g C E A E C`

The same four strings in eighths: twice through in a bar of 4/4; in 3/4 and 6/8, up across them and back.

Count	1	&	2	&	3	&
Finger	p	i	m	a	m	i
String	g	C	E	A	E	C

Fingers: p thumb · i index · m middle · a ring. + means picked together; · is a rest. Hold the whole chord shape and pick from it: every fret number in the tab is already under a finger.

The chords



The song

VERSE

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  C                                                 G7
A|---------3--------|------3-----|------3-----|------2-----|
E|------0-----0-----|----0---0---|----0---0---|----1---1---|
C|---0-----------0--|--0-------0-|--0-------0-|--2-------2-|
G|0-----------------|0-----------|0-----------|0-----------|
  Lullaby, and good  night, with  roses be     dight, with

  G7                                                C
A|------2-----|------2-----|---------2--------|------3-----|
E|----1---1---|----1---1---|------1-----1-----|----0---0---|
C|--2-------2-|--2-------2-|---2-----------2--|--0-------0-|
G|0-----------|0-----------|0-----------------|0-----------|
  lilies       o'erspread   is baby's wee      bed.
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```
  F                     C                 G7          C
A|------------0----------|---------3--------|------2-----|------3-----|
E|--------1-------1-------|------0-----0-----|----1---1---|----0---0---|
C|----0---------------0---|---0-----------0--|--2-------2-|--0-------0-|
G|2-----------------------|0-----------------|0-----------|0-----------|
  Lay thee down now and    rest, may thy      slumber be   blessed.

  F                     C                 G7          C
A|------------0----------|---------3--------|------2-----|------3-----|
E|--------1-------1-------|------0-----0-----|----1---1---|----0---0---|
C|----0---------------0---|---0-----------0--|--2-------2-|--0-------0-|
G|2-----------------------|0-----------------|0-----------|0-----------|
  Lay thee down now and    rest, may thy      slumber be   blessed.
```

How to learn it

1. Hold one chord and play the pattern over and over, slowly, until your picking hand does it on its own.
2. Change chords on beat 1: the new shape has to be down by the time your thumb picks.
3. Then the song, slowly (Pick → Play, with the practice speed turned down), up to speed over a few days.
4. Then sing over it. If the words throw your fingers, go back to an easier pattern for a while.

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